MAICON

FORWARD

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(AI-Generated Session Notes)

Build Your Own Marketing App in 40 Minutes, No Code Required

Date & time: Oct. 15, 11:40 AM-12:25 PM
Track: Build



Brian Brinkman

Partner, Stream Creative

- LinkedIn

Session Description

A hands-on build session using Google AI Studio.

This isn't a session about what AI could do—it's a chance to build something that works.

Using Google AI Studio, you'll turn a real marketing task into a functional AI-powered tool you can put to work right away. No coding experience, complicated setup, or APIs required. We'll build together, step by step, so you can see firsthand how quickly an idea can become a working application.

Bring your laptop and a marketing task, workflow, or challenge you'd love to automate. You'll leave with more than inspiration; you'll leave with something you built yourself.

Note: A laptop and Google AI Studio account is needed to participate, which is free with a Google account.

Key Quote

> *"So if you said, Brian, build me this app that does this, I can definitely build you something. But I can't build it as well as you."* **- Brian Brinkman**

Session Summary

Brian Brinkman, founding partner of Stream Creative, a full-service marketing and sales agency in Milwaukee, led one of MAICON's first workshop-format sessions on the Build track. His goal was for every attendee to leave with a working app they built themselves, rather than a camera roll of slides they would never look at again. The tool was Google AI Studio, which he chose because it is no-code, quick to start, and comes with Google's "superpowers" like Maps, YouTube, and Gmail already connected, with Google Cloud available if a project needs to scale. The only coding language required, he joked, was English.

Brinkman had attendees brainstorm use cases across a few buckets: productivity, content, research, calculators, games, and, most important to him, whatever annoys you in your job. He then walked through building in AI Studio: describe the app in plain language (by voice or typing), be clear about the inputs and the end state you want, and use features like the "I'm

Feeling Lucky" button, the app gallery, and built-in connections such as the Nano Banana image model, Google Drive, Calendar, and Slides. Live on stage, he dictated an app that takes a company URL, learns its product and brand, suggests three headlines, and creates branded images sized for Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn.

While attendees built, he shared apps he made the same way. They included a personal airport departure planner, an image optimizer that writes SEO alt text and file names and crops images for web pages (popular enough with his team that he opened it to clients), and a brand intelligence tool that pulls a company's positioning, tone, competitors, tech stack, and buyer personas. He also showed an Oregon Trail-style game built for a plastic injection molding client, with Gemini generating each playthrough and Nano Banana creating the finished part, to give the client something worth sharing on LinkedIn.

He paired the hands-on work with practical tips and guardrails. If an app has errors, use the built-in fix button, or paste a screenshot or error message back in and ask for a fix. Avoid client or confidential data, and treat apps as prototypes to bring to IT and legal teams for anything enterprise-level. Remember that the builder owns support, set spending limits to avoid surprise bills, and never paste keys or passwords into a prompt; store them in AI Studio's Secrets setting instead. His summary: start small, start contained, and start with you.

Attendees shared what they had built in minutes, including a newsletter assembler that drafts in Mailchimp, a booking and payment app for a teenager's dog waste pickup business, a branded game for a plumbing manufacturer, a daily competitor-monitoring report, and an industry-specific content generator for a sales team. Brinkman closed by encouraging everyone to see themselves as a builder. Their domain expertise about their customers and processes, he said, is what makes their apps better than anything an outside developer could build for them.

Key Takeaways

- **English is the coding language.** Describe the app in plain language, including the inputs and the end result you want, and Google AI Studio builds it without code or API setup.
- **Start with what annoys you.** Repetitive or frustrating tasks, like naming and tagging dozens of web images, make some of the most valuable first apps.
- **Small personal tools are worth building.** An app you would never hire a developer for, like his airport departure planner, can now be built in about 15 minutes.
- **Iterate instead of expecting perfection.** Use the fix button, marked-up screenshots, and error messages to refine an app that gets you 80% of the way there.
- **Start small, contained, and with you.** Keep confidential data out, store keys in Secrets, set spending limits, and bring in IT and legal before scaling a prototype.
- **Your domain expertise is the advantage.** Everyone can be a builder, and people who know their customers and processes will build better tools than an outside developer.